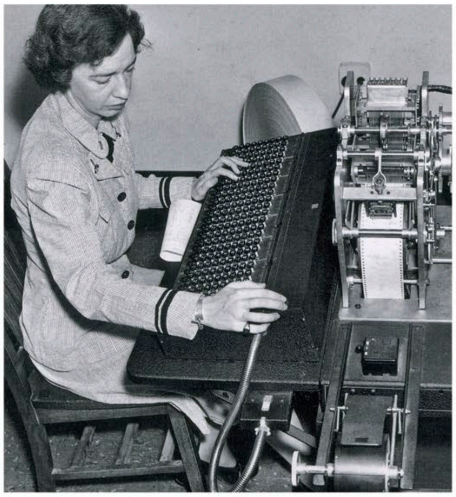


◂ PROGRAMMING "MARK 1," 1944

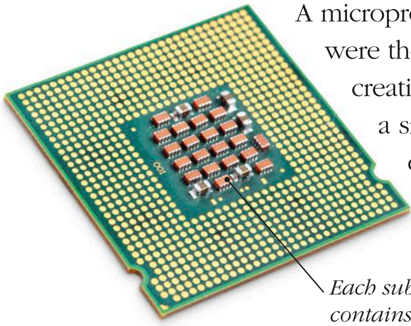
Grace Hopper is seen here programming Howard Aiken's "Mark 1" computer, which made calculations used to design the atomic bomb during World War II.

GRACE HOPPER

In the 1940s, Grace Hopper was a US Navy admiral and one of the first computer programmers. She helped develop one of the first programming languages, called COBOL, which is still in use. She also coined the term "computer bug" when she took a trapped moth out of a computer.

GETTING SMALLER AND FASTER

A microprocessor is a computer's "engine." Early computers were the size of a large closet or bigger. In 1947, the creation of transistors shrunk the workings down to a small integrated circuit board that could carry out operations at incredible speeds, and computers became smaller.

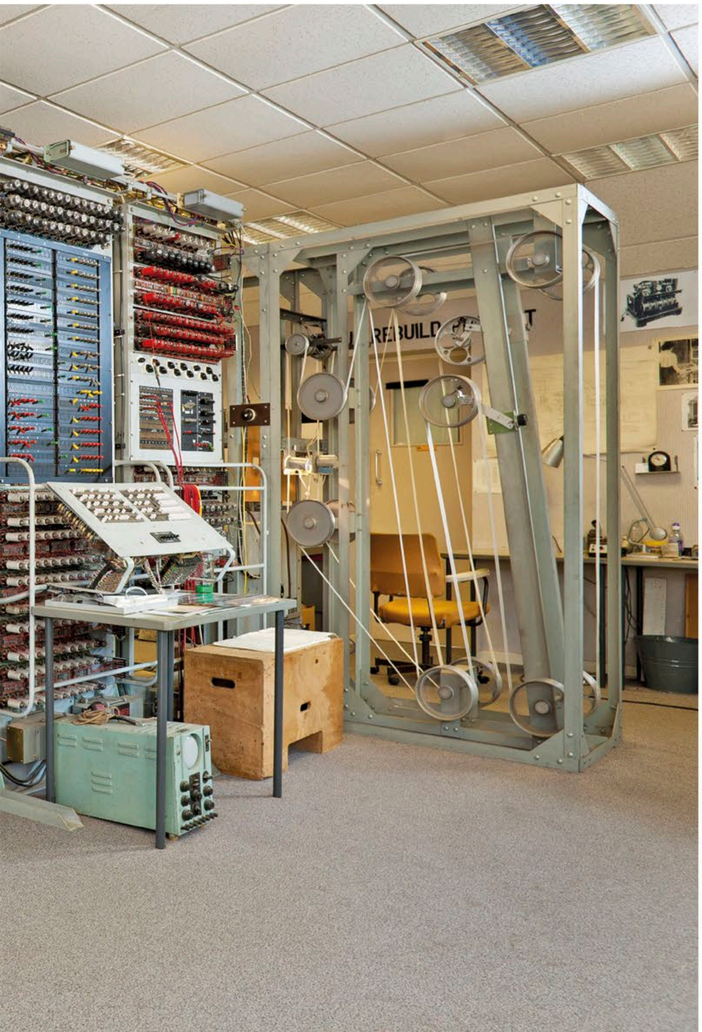


Each sub-circuit of this early processor contains thousands of transistors.

COMPUTER MOUSE

In 1963, American engineer Douglas Engelbart came up with a wheeled device that could move a computer cursor. He called it a "bug." His colleague, Bill English, renamed it a "mouse" the following year.

First mouse, made of wood



IBM PC from the 1980s

PERSONAL COMPUTER

The first personal computers (PCs), created in the 1970s, were self-assembly kits for experts only. The personal computer revolution truly began in 1981 when IBM launched its first PCs, changing forever the way people work, play, and communicate.